In an interview with the *Financial Times*, Ratan shared the dilemma he faced while making the final bid. He said, ‘We all felt that to lose would go beyond the group and it would be an issue of great disappointment in the country. So on the one hand, you want to do the right thing by your shareholders and on the other hand, you did not want to lose.’ In his statement in the year’s annual report, he sounded optimistic when he said: ‘I believe that when one looks back at this acquisition—even at this price, it will be seen as a bold visionary move.’

Muthuraman thinks that the acquisition made the Tatas a truly ‘global brand’ with a global presence. It gave the organization ‘valuable experience’ and ‘exposed the group to modern practices’. Many Tata veterans also felt that the acquisition, made in the centenary year of Tata Steel, would bode well for the group.

Tata Steel was now poised to be the world’s fifth-biggest steel maker in terms of output. The acquisition of Corus transformed it from a domestic steel producer to an international steel company of global scale. For a country that had been increasingly looking to take its place among leading economies, it made Ratan a national corporate hero overnight. He had indeed pursued Corus with a vengeance, fuelled by Indian pride.

He received kudos from all quarters. Felicitations came from abroad too. He was personally congratulated by Maria J.A. van der Hoeven, minister of economic affairs of the Netherlands. In her letter, she said that she considered the victory of Tata Steel as a ‘positive development’.

A question that nagged the Indian industrial circles was what had motivated Ratan to undertake this acquisition. There were strong indications that the June 2006 takeover of Arcelor by Mittal Steel was the trigger. The ArcelorMittal Group had, as a result, become the largest steel company in the world. Some commented that Ratan was unhappy that he had lost the opportunity to be the first one to put India on the world business map in a significant way. In an increasingly competitive arena of ‘grandiose plans for global domination’, he felt the pressure to act, wrote the *Financial Times*.

Ratan, however, denied that the Arcelor deal had influenced him in any way. In a newspaper interview given six hours after he had clinched the Corus mega deal, he stated, ‘We had started talking to Corus much before Mittal started talking to Arcelor. And we didn’t go to Corus. They came to us.’